MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM

MGU-UGP (Honours) / MGU-BBA (Honours) / MGU-BCA (Honours)
REGULAR EXAMINATION – OCTOBER 2026 | FIFTH SEMESTER
DISCIPLINE SPECIFIC CORE COURSE (DSC)
MG5DSCSAC301 – YOGA AND WELLNESS
(2024 ADMISSION ONWARDS)

Duration: 1 hour 30 minutes Maximum Marks: 50

PART A – MCQ

Answer all questions. Each question carries 1 mark. [1 × 10 = 10]

1. Bhakti Yoga is primarily based on: [U] / [CO1]

- a) Selfless service
- b) Devotion and love towards the divine
- c) Physical postures
- d) Sense withdrawal

Correct answer: b) Devotion and love towards the divine.

2. Yoga may support emotional wellbeing by promoting: [U] / [CO5]

- a) Emotional regulation and self-awareness
- b) Social isolation
- c) Negative thinking
- d) Emotional instability

Correct answer: a) Emotional regulation and self-awareness.

3. A person modifies the duration and intensity of Yoga according to their daily schedule while maintaining regular practice. This demonstrates: [A] / [CO6]

- a) Adaptability in practice
- b) Competitive training
- c) Maximum overload
- d) Random training

Correct answer: a) Adaptability in practice.

4. Paschimottanasana is primarily classified as a: [K] / [CO3]

- a) Backbend
- b) Forward bend
- c) Inversion
- d) Balancing posture

Correct answer: b) Forward bend.

5. Which of the following represents the first limb of Ashtanga Yoga? [K] / [CO1]

- a) Asana
- b) Yama
- c) Pranayama
- d) Samadhi

Correct answer: b) Yama.

6. Visualization Meditation primarily involves: [U] / [CO5]

- a) Creating and sustaining a mental image
- b) Performing rapid breathing
- c) Holding a difficult posture
- d) Performing physical cleansing

Correct answer: a) Creating and sustaining a mental image.

7. Which of the following is specifically mentioned for weight reduction? [K] / [CO6]

- a) Surya Namaskar
- b) Savasana
- c) Sukhasana
- d) Vajrasana

Correct answer: a) Surya Namaskar.

8. Which Asana is included for musculoskeletal conditions? [K] / [CO2]

- a) Bhujangasana
- b) Malasana
- c) Sukhasana
- d) Ananda Balasana

Correct answer: a) Bhujangasana.

9. One important psychological benefit of Yoga is improved: [U] / [CO2]

- a) Emotional regulation
- b) Aggression
- c) Negative thinking
- d) Mental confusion

Correct answer: a) Emotional regulation.

10. Which of the following is commonly considered a meditation technique? [K] / [CO2]

- a) Mindfulness meditation
- b) Weight training
- c) Sprint training
- d) Circuit training

Correct answer: a) Mindfulness meditation.

PART B – SHORT ANSWER

Answer any 10 questions. Each question carries 2 marks. [2 × 10 = 20]

11. How does Tadasana help in developing proper body alignment and posture? [U] / [CO3]

- It encourages an upright standing position with the head, shoulders, spine and hips aligned.
- It develops body awareness and helps distribute weight evenly through both feet.
- Regular practice may help improve balance and postural awareness.

12. Mention any two physical benefits of regular Pranayama practice. [K] / [CO3]

- It can improve awareness and control of breathing.
- Slow, comfortable breathing may promote relaxation and help reduce physical tension.
- Some breathing practices may support respiratory efficiency when performed appropriately.

13. Name any two cooling Pranayama techniques and state their purpose. [U] / [CO6]

- Sheetali: inhalation through a rolled tongue; traditionally practised for a cooling and calming effect.
- Sheetkari: inhalation through the teeth; traditionally practised for a cooling effect.
- Both should be practised gently and stopped if discomfort occurs.

14. Why is breath coordination important while performing an Asana? [U] / [CO3]

- It coordinates movements with inhalation and exhalation.
- It supports concentration and smooth, controlled movement.
- Avoid holding the breath or forcing it during a posture.

15. Define any two schools of Yoga. [K] / [CO1]

- Bhakti Yoga: the path of devotion and love towards the divine.
- Karma Yoga: the path of selfless action without attachment to results.
- Jnana Yoga is the path of knowledge and inquiry; Raja Yoga emphasises mental discipline and meditation.

16. State any two purposes of Kriya practices in Yoga. [K] / [CO3]

- Kriyas are traditional cleansing practices used to cleanse particular body passages.
- They are intended to prepare the body for other yogic practices.
- Some Kriyas are advanced and should be learned only with qualified supervision.

17. How does Pavanamuktasana differ from Setu Bandhasana in terms of their primary benefits? [An] / [CO3]

- Pavanamuktasana brings the knees towards the chest and is commonly associated with relieving abdominal gas and supporting digestion.
- Setu Bandhasana lifts the pelvis and chest and strengthens the back and gluteal muscles.
- Setu Bandhasana also gently opens the chest, while Pavanamuktasana focuses more on abdominal compression.

18. State any two factors to be considered when modifying Yoga practice for an injured athlete. [K] / [CO6]

- Consider the type, location and severity of the injury and any medical restrictions.
- Consider pain, range of motion and the stage of rehabilitation.
- Modify duration and intensity, and avoid movements that increase pain.

19. Explain the role of Yoga in improving concentration and focus at work. [U] / [CO2]

- Mindfulness and breathing practices train attention to stay on the present task.
- Relaxation may reduce stress and distracting thoughts.
- Regular practice may help the person respond more calmly to work pressure.

20. What is Dhauti in yogic practice? [K] / [CO3]

- Dhauti is one of the traditional Shatkarma cleansing practices in Yoga.
- It refers to techniques intended to cleanse parts of the digestive tract or related passages.
- Advanced forms can be risky and should not be attempted without qualified guidance.

21. What is meant by sport-specific Yoga practice? [K] / [CO2]

- It means adapting Yoga practices to the demands of a particular sport.

- It may use suitable postures, breathing and relaxation to support sport-related mobility, balance, recovery or focus.
- The programme should reflect the athlete's sport, fitness level and injury history.

22. Explain how the objectives of Yoga have evolved from ancient to modern times. [An] / [CO1]

- Traditionally, Yoga focused on spiritual development, self-discipline, meditation and self-realisation.
- It also emphasised ethical living and control of the mind.
- Modern practice commonly includes fitness, flexibility, stress management and general wellbeing.
- Traditional spiritual aims remain important for many practitioners today.

PART C – SHORT ESSAY

Answer any 4 questions. Each question carries 5 marks. [5 × 4 = 20]

23. Explain the important precautions and contraindications to be considered while performing inverted Asanas. [A] / [CO6]

- Learn inverted Asanas under the guidance of a qualified Yoga instructor, particularly as a beginner.
- Warm up properly and enter and leave the posture slowly; avoid jerky movements.
- Do not force the neck or place excessive pressure on the head and cervical spine.
- People with uncontrolled high blood pressure, glaucoma or other serious eye conditions, significant neck/spinal problems, or certain heart conditions should avoid some inversions unless medically cleared.
- During pregnancy, or after an injury or surgery, obtain individual clinical advice before attempting inversions.
- Stop immediately if pain, dizziness, breathlessness, visual disturbance or unusual discomfort occurs.
- Use suitable support and a non-slip surface; avoid practice when exhausted.
- Avoid competing with others or holding the posture longer than comfortable.

24. Develop a short Yoga-based programme that combines suitable Asanas and Pranayama for reducing stress and promoting relaxation. [C] / [CO6]

- Begin in a quiet place with comfortable sitting and natural breathing for 2 minutes.
- Do gentle neck and shoulder movements for about 2 minutes, without forcing the joints.
- Practise Tadasana for 1 minute, followed by gentle cat-cow movements for 2 minutes.
- Practise Balasana for about 2 minutes and a comfortable seated forward bend if appropriate.
- Perform slow diaphragmatic breathing or gentle alternate-nostril breathing for 3–4 minutes; do not force the breath or hold it.
- Finish in Savasana for 3–5 minutes, consciously relaxing the muscles.

25. Discuss the effects of Yoga on cardiovascular and respiratory functions. [U] / [CO2]

- Slow breathing and relaxation may reduce stress-related arousal and support a calmer heart rate.
- Regular, appropriate Yoga practice may support blood-pressure management as part of a healthy lifestyle; it does not replace medical treatment.
- Postures and movement provide gentle physical activity and may support circulation and functional fitness.
- Pranayama develops awareness and control of inhalation and exhalation.
- Breathing exercises may support respiratory muscle control and breathing efficiency in some practitioners.
- Relaxation may reduce the feeling of breathlessness associated with anxiety in some situations.

26. Develop a simple daily Yoga programme combining Asanas, Pranayama and healthy lifestyle practices for improving energy and vitality. [C] / [CO6]

- Start with 2–3 minutes of quiet sitting and gentle warm-up movements.
- Practise Surya Namaskar at a comfortable pace, for example 3–6 rounds according to ability.
- Add suitable Asanas such as Tadasana, Trikonasana and Bhujangasana, avoiding pain or strain.

- Practise gentle Pranayama, such as slow diaphragmatic breathing or Nadi Shodhana without breath retention, for 3–5 minutes.
- Finish with Savasana or quiet relaxation for 3–5 minutes.
- Maintain a balanced diet, adequate hydration, sufficient sleep and regular physical activity.

27. A beginner is learning Pranayama for the first time. Explain the basic principles that should be followed for safe and effective practice. [A] / [CO6]

- Learn from a qualified instructor and begin with simple breathing techniques.
- Choose a clean, quiet and well-ventilated place; sit comfortably with the spine naturally upright.
- Start with natural, slow and smooth breathing without straining.
- Do not force inhalation or exhalation, over-breathe or hold the breath as a beginner.
- Start with a short duration and increase gradually as comfort and control improve.
- Practise when comfortable, preferably not immediately after a heavy meal.
- Stop if dizziness, tingling, chest discomfort, anxiety or unusual breathlessness occurs and return to normal breathing.
- People with significant heart or respiratory conditions should seek clinical advice before starting.
- Regularity and comfort are more important than forceful or prolonged practice.

28. Describe the benefits of Savasana, Ananda Balasana and Sukhasana for mental health and relaxation. [U] / [CO2]

- Savasana allows the whole body to rest and may reduce perceived tension and support calm awareness of breathing.
- Ananda Balasana gently moves the hips and may help release tension around the hips and lower back when performed comfortably.
- Sukhasana provides a stable seated position for mindful breathing or meditation.
- These postures can help a person pause, settle attention and reduce the sense of stress.
- Regular comfortable practice may support relaxation, emotional wellbeing and body awareness.